

Vihaan S Shinde

CSE-AIML

Company: Oracle Financial Software Services (OFSS)

Job Profile: Associate Application Developer

Offer Type: Placement Only

CTC: 15.23 LPA

Location: Mumbai/Pune/Bangalore/Chennai

Resume :  Resume (Vihaan Shinde).pdf

Placement Process:

Online Assessment - 15-09-2025

F2F Interviews - 17-09-2025

1. Online Assessment Round [~ 125 Candidates Appeared]

Platform: HackerRank

Total Duration: 95 minutes

Sections: 4

Section Breakdown

1. **DSA Question 1** – Basic problem on arrays (1 question)

2. **MCQs – Computer Science & Related Topics**

- OS, Computer Networks, DBMS
- Cloud services
- Debugging
- Data structures
- **Total:** ~25 MCQs

3. **MCQs – Aptitude**

- Quantitative and logical reasoning
- **Total:** ~10–11 MCQs

4. **DSA Question 2** – Slightly difficult problem on arrays (1 question)

My Approach

- Started with the **first DSA question** (array-based, straightforward).
- Then moved on to **MCQs** (CS fundamentals + cloud + debugging + DS + aptitude), which consumed the majority of my time.
- Finally attempted the **second DSA question**, which was comparatively difficult. I managed to clear **partial test cases** for it.

NOTE - DO NOT UNDERESTIMATE APTITUDE – IT IS JUST AS IMPORTANT AS YOUR DSA AND PLAYS A CRUCIAL ROLE IN GETTING SHORTLISTED FOR THE NEXT ROUND.

Links : APTITUDE (IMPORTANT)

1. <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLpyc33gOcbVA4qXMoQ5vmhefTruk5t9lt>

2. <https://www.indiabix.com/>

3. If time permits - <https://bodheeprep.com/free-cat-quant-practice-questions>

2. Technical Round 1 [25 candidates appeared for this round]

The reporting time at college was **8:45 AM** as OFSS was scheduled to conduct their **Pre-Placement Talk (PPT)** for the shortlisted students. However, due to some delays, the PPT wrapped up only around **11:00–11:30 AM**, after which the interviews began.

I was called for my **first interview at 3:30 PM**. By that time, most of my peers had already given two interviews, and some were unfortunately rejected.

I walked into the room, greeted the interviewer, and was pleasantly surprised to find that she was very **chill and friendly**. With around **15 years of experience at OFSS**, she carried a calm yet professional demeanor that helped ease my nerves.

I began with a **brief introduction**, after which the conversation quickly shifted to my **projects**.

Project Discussion

- She asked me to explain the **implementation details in depth** of the first project I mentioned.
- Then, she posed a situational question: *“If X problem occurs, how would you solve it technically, and what could be the potential reason behind it?”*
 - Since I primarily work in **Machine Learning**, I clarified that I am not deeply into development but still answered based on my knowledge.
 - She seemed **satisfied with my explanation**.
- We then moved through all the other projects listed on my resume, and even discussed a few **hackathon-winning projects** that were not on the resume.

The interviewer also asked:

- **“How do you distribute work in a group and handle conflicts?”**
 - I shared my experience of working in teams and explained how we ensured smooth collaboration.
- **“Which programming language do you prefer?”**
 - I said C++, since it was the first language I learned.
 - She asked, *“Why not Java?”*
 - I explained that I was most comfortable with C++, though if given an option among **Java, C++, and Python**, I would still lean toward C++.
 - She pointed out that C++ is quite old and asked me to justify it. I confidently presented **use cases and advantages** where C++ still shines. She seemed convinced with my reasoning.
 - To show adaptability, I added that I would also **love to learn Java** since it’s widely used and in trend, highlighting my **willingness to learn new technologies**.

Towards the end, she asked if I had any questions. I prepared and asked **three questions**, which led to a **fruitful discussion lasting 10–15 minutes**.

This Round Lasted for around 40-45 mins.

Learnings

- **Be careful and confident while introducing and explaining yourself.** Interviewers can easily sense if you’re faking something. **Authenticity matters.**
- This round was **heavily project-focused**. It tested how well you can **present your work, defend your choices, and explain your technology stack**.

- **Be 100% sure about what you have built.** If it's on your resume, you should be able to explain it thoroughly.

After 10 mins I was called for Round 2

3. Technical Round 2 [~ 12-14 Candidates]

By the time my **Round 2** came up, I was one of the **last candidates** to be interviewed. Many interviewers had already left, so I knew I had to **give my best to make an impression**.

I entered the room, greeted the interviewer, but initially, he didn't seem very interested. He skipped the introduction part altogether and **jumped directly into project discussions**.

Project & Technical Discussion

- He picked the **third project on my resume** and asked me to explain it.
 - I explained the project **step by step in detail**, covering the entire implementation.
- After the explanation, he shifted focus to **Large Language Models (LLMs)** and asked:
 - How do **LLMs work (Encoder-Decoder Overview & How it generates response)**?
 - Which models have I personally used?
 - Why is the **quality of responses different across LLMs**?
 - I answered all these questions confidently, and he seemed **satisfied with my explanations**.

Coding & SQL Tasks

- Next, he asked me to **write a C++ code** to count **character frequencies**.
 - I wrote the code systematically on paper (as they were evaluating written solutions).
- Then, he moved to **SQL**:
 - Task: *Find the 2nd smallest number from a table containing duplicate values.*
 - I solved it using **CTEs and the DENSE_RANK() window function**.
- After SQL, he asked me to **explain the same project again**, but this time **on paper**, step by step.
 - He also raised a few counter-questions, which I handled well.
- Finally, he asked:
 - **"What is the difference between Machine Learning and Deep Learning?"**
 - I explained the distinction clearly, which concluded the technical questioning.

Closing Discussion

The interviewer now seemed more engaged. We ended the interview on a **positive note** with a light discussion about:

- **AI trends**
- How the company is **heavily investing in AI**
- My views on the future of this domain

Learnings

- **First impressions matter, but consistency seals it.** Even if the interviewer seems disinterested, maintain energy and confidence.
- **Projects are your strongest asset** – be ready to explain them multiple times, even on paper, and defend your choices.
- **Be thorough with basics in C++, SQL, and core concepts** – they often act as filters.
- **Stay updated with AI/ML advancements** – it shows genuine interest in your field.

***Round Lasted for 40-45 mins.**

Round 3

HR Discussion

- The HR directly informed us that **we were selected**.
- HR asked whether I had any questions.
- She also asked for our **preferred job location**.
- Before closing, she advised us to **enjoy the remaining days of college life**, as professional life would soon begin.

My Journey Before OFSS

Before getting selected at OFSS, I had already gone through a series of **ups and downs** in my placement journey.

I appeared for **InCred Finance** and reached till the last round, but unfortunately got **rejected** there. Then

came an opportunity with **BlackRock**, where I was considered for a **Data Operations role**. Out of the candidates, **10 were selected and 3 (including me) were waitlisted**. That moment hit me hard being *so close yet not through* was one of the most disheartening setbacks I faced.

I also participated in **Nomura's Kakushin Hackathon**, where I reached the **presentation stage**, but again faced rejection.

These multiple setbacks took a toll on me. I remember being the most disheartened during the **BlackRock waitlist phase** watching others move ahead while I was stuck in uncertainty. But through it all, my **family stood strong beside me**. They constantly reminded me, *"God has something bigger planned for you."*

And truly, they were right. That bigger plan unfolded when I got selected at **OFSS**. Looking back, I feel nothing but **thankfulness and gratitude** to my **parents**, to my **friends** for their endless support, and to my **college** for providing me this opportunity.

Key Takeaways for Preparation

1. Maintain a Strong CGPA

- A **CGPA ≥ 7.5 is mandatory** – aim higher to stay safe.

2. Know Your Resume Inside Out

- Be ready to explain **every detail of your projects and experiences**.
- **Do not fake anything** – honesty is valued more than exaggeration.

3. Focus on Aptitude

- Aptitude is a **crucial shortlisting factor** – give it equal importance as DSA.

4. Practice DSA Daily

- Strengthen your problem-solving skills.
- Also, build an understanding of **how DSA concepts are applied in real-world scenarios**.

5. Master CS Fundamentals (*priority order*)

- **OOPS == DBMS $\rightarrow$ OS == CCN**

- These topics form the backbone of most technical interviews.

6. Showcase All-Round Skills

- Highlight **leadership qualities** and **extra-curricular activities**.
- Companies value candidates who are **not just technically strong but also versatile**.

7. Believe in Yourself

- Confidence, consistency, and self-belief are key to overcoming rejections and moving forward.

Reference Links :

DSA - <https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/strivers-a2z-dsa-course-sheet-2/>

Learn SQL - <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLBv9GORP5VkcImbvgNaEB3GBFc-weefX7>

Practice SQL - Solve LeetCode SQL50 at least twice to get a strong hold on SQL.

DBMS - <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLDzeHZWIZsTpukcmA2p5rhHM14bl2dHU>

OOPS - https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL9gnSGHSqcnolG3XjUbWzXHL8_EttOuKk

OS - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8XBtAjKwCm4>

CCN - <https://youtu.be/IPvYjXCSTg8?si=IQDYEUK6fDZTSP6O>

Guesstimates - https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLp03oxs_6O-lhB-1sHM9GGoO7-lzFe25a

Puzzle Questions - <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude/top-100-puzzles-asked-in-interviews/>

Refer GFG Top 50 Interview Questions for any Subject

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“All the very best , stay optimistic and trust the process”